

ENVS 193DS Final

Matthew Schoen

2026-06-09

Table of contents

Set Up	2
Problem 1: Research Writing	2
a. Transparents Statistical Methods	2
b. Suggestions for rewriting	3
c. Further Analysis	3
Problem 2: Data Analysis	3
a. Clean & Wrangle	3
b. Response Variable	4
c. Purpose of the Study	5
d. Table of Models	5
e. Run the Models	5
f. Select the Best Model	5
g. Check the Diagnostics	6
h. Visualize the Model Predictions	7
i. Write A Figure Caption	8
j. Calculate Model Predictions	9
k. Interpret Your Results	9
Problem 3: Affective and Exploratory Visualizations	10
a. Comparing Visualizations	10
b. Designing An Analysis	11
c. Check Any Assumptions and Run Your Analysis	11
Checking Assumptions	11
Running Proposed Analysis	14
d. Create a Visualization	15
e. Write a Caption	16
f. Write About Your Results	17

Link to ENV5 193DS Final GitHub Repo: [HERE](#)

Set Up

```
# Reading in packages necessary to complete the assignment
library(janitor)
library(tidyverse)
library(here)
library(readxl)
library(flextable)
library(DHARMA)
library(MuMIn)
library(ggeffects)

# Reading in the nest data & storing it as an object
nest <- read_csv(here("data", "nest_data_final.csv"))

# Reading in personal data & storing it as an object
step_count <- read_csv(
  here("data", "MyData_HW3_Format.csv"))
```

Problem 1: Research Writing

a. Transparents Statistical Methods

Part 1:

In part 1, they more than likely used a logistic regression as the response variable is the probability of American Avocet microhabitat use while the predictor variable is the distance to the water's edge.

Part 2:

In part 2, they more than likely used a chi-square test of independence as both bird species and habitat type are categorical variables and the analysis looks to examine how the distribution of bird species differs among habitat type.

b. Suggestions for rewriting

Part 1:

American Avocet tuse of micro-habitats varies wiht distance from the water edge. This suggests that proximity to water influences where and how the American Avocet chooses to use habitats.

Part 2:

American Avocets, Forster's Terns, and Black-necked Stilts used habitat types differently. This suggests that each species has habitat preference differs within the San Francisco Bay estuary.

c. Further Analysis

To further the analysis, examining how the type of vegetation cover within a given area influences American Avocet habitat use. This *continuous variable* could be measured as a percentage (%) of ground cover within the study area using quadrats set at a given dimension (ex: 1m x 1m, 3ft x 3ft) and could showcase how other factors affected by vegetation cover (food, nesting area, protection from predators) influences behavior.

Problem 2: Data Analysis

Goal: Answer the following questions

- 1) How do tree height and acacia ant species influence the probability of bird nest occurrence (of any species of birds)?
- 2) Does acacia ant species identity influence the effect of tree height on probability of nest occurrence differ depending on acacia ant species?

a. Clean & Wrangle

```
# Creating new clean object from nest
nests_clean <- nest |>
  # selecting only the necessary columns
  select("case_control", # selecting case_control
         "height_cm", # selecting bird_speces
         "ant_species") |> # selecting ant_species
  # filtering ant_species for the specified species
  filter(ant_species %in% c("RRB", "AB", "BBR")) |>
```

```

# Creating new column with spelled out names
mutate(ant_species,
       ant_species_name = case_when( # specifying specific names in the new column
         ant_species == "AB" ~ "Crematogaster sjostedti",
         ant_species == "RRB" ~ "Crematogaster mimosae",
         ant_species == "BBR" ~ "Crematogaster nigriceps")) |>
# reordering ant species as specified
mutate(ant_species_name =
       fct_relevel(ant_species_name,
         "Crematogaster sjostedti",
         "Crematogaster mimosae",
         "Crematogaster nigriceps"))

# Displaying structure of nests_clean
str(nests_clean)

```

```

'data.frame':  270 obs. of  4 variables:
 $ case_control    : int  1 0 0 0 0 1 0 0 0 1 ...
 $ height_cm       : num  392 310 513 154 324 ...
 $ ant_species     : chr  "RRB" "RRB" "RRB" "RRB" ...
 $ ant_species_name: Factor w/ 3 levels "Crematogaster sjostedti",...: 2 2 2 2 1 2 3 2 1 3 ..

```

```

# Displaying 10 random rows within the data set
slice_sample(nests_clean, n = 10)

```

	case_control	height_cm	ant_species	ant_species_name
1	0	279.0	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
2	0	170.5	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
3	0	150.0	BBR	Crematogaster nigriceps
4	0	241.5	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
5	0	264.5	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
6	0	125.0	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
7	0	208.0	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
8	0	153.5	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
9	0	269.5	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae
10	0	427.0	RRB	Crematogaster mimosae

b. Response Variable

In this data set, “case_control” is made up of a binary system where 1 indicates a bird nest is present in a tree while 0 indicates no bird nests were found within a tree. This is important

when assessing how/why birds choose specific trees for nesting.

c. Purpose of the Study

Tree Height:

Tree height is a continuous variable measured in centimeters. As tree height increases, the probability of nest occurrence increases as a taller tree provides greater protection from predators, visibility, and increases structural support to the nest itself (Found in the “Introduction” section).

Ant Species:

Ant species is a discrete categorical variable as it contains three distinct “categories” which in this case are the different species of ants: *Crematogaster sjostedti*, *Crematogaster mimosae*, and *Crematogaster nigriceps*. The species of ant can influence nesting probability as different species of ants vary in their overall “aggressiveness” toward other organisms which in turn alters tree structure and can affect the overall suitability of a tree for nesting. (Found in Introduction & Methods).

d. Table of Models

Model number	Tree Height	Ant Species	Interaction	Predictor list
1	X	X	X	All predictors (Tree height and ant species) with an interaction
2	X	X		Tree Height and Ant Species (No Interaction)

Figure 1: Overview of the two models being run

e. Run the Models

f. Select the Best Model

```
# Running an AIC
AIC(
  model1, # specifying model 1
  model2) # specifying model 2
```

	df	AIC
model11	6	237.8042
model12	4	258.7430

The best model as determined by Akaike's Information Criterion (AIC) included both predictors, tree height (cm) and ant species, and the interaction between both of them (AIC = 237.8). The results suggest that a relationship exists between tree height and the probability of nest occurrence based off the species of acacia ant.

g. Check the Diagnostics

```
# Plotting Residuals for model 1
plot(simulateResiduals(model11))
```

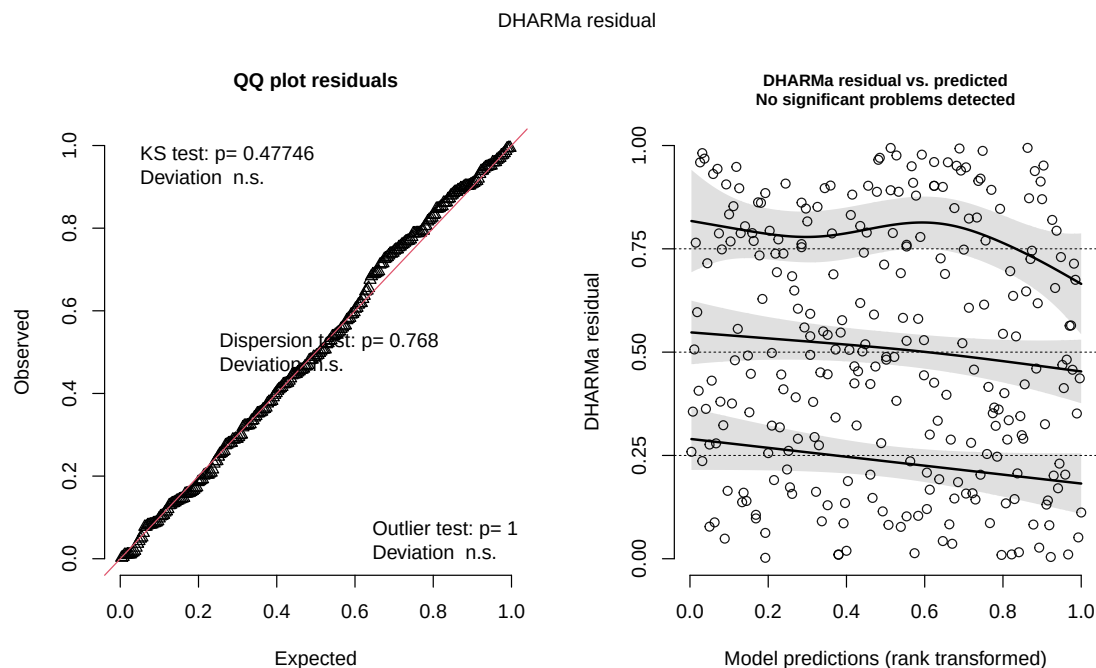


Figure 2: DHARMa Residuals diagnostics for the selected logistic regression model predicting bird nest occurrence from tree height, acacia ant species, and their interaction. The left panel shows a QQ plot comparing simulated and expected residual distributions. The right displays DHARMa residuals plotted against model predictions.

h. Visualize the Model Predictions

```
preds <- ggpredict(  
  model1, # creating a prediction for model 1  
  terms = c("height_cm", # specifying height_cm  
            "ant_species_name")) #specifying ant species name
```

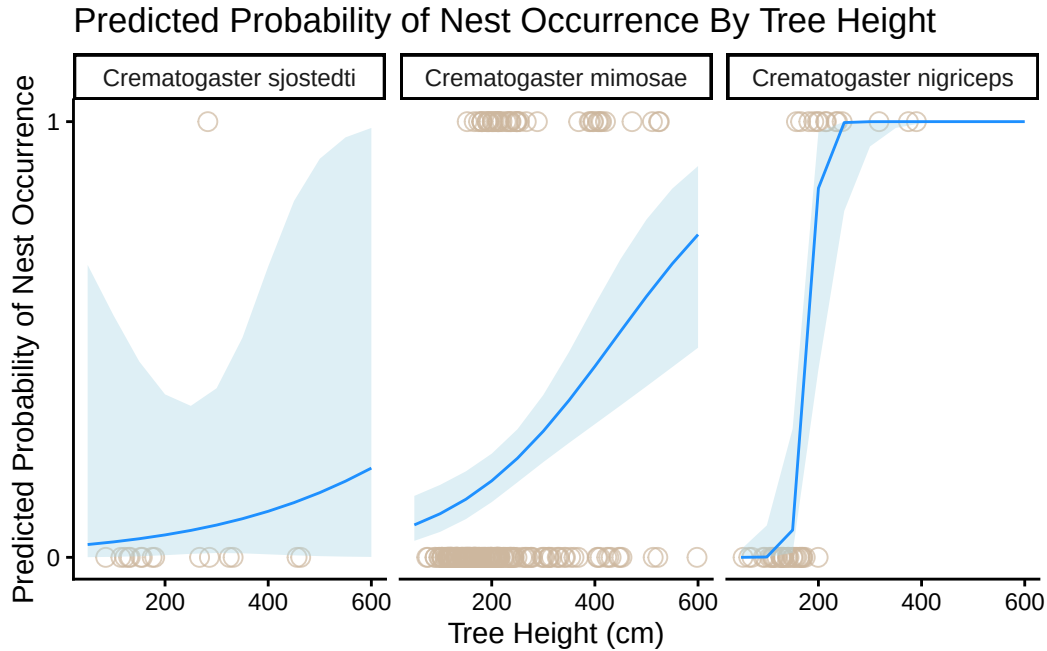
Data were 'prettified'. Consider using `terms="height\_cm [all]"` to get smooth plots.

```
# Creating new object  
preds <- rename(preds, "ant_species_name" = "group")  
  
# ggplot as base layer  
ggplot(data = nests_clean, # specifying nests_clean as data set  
       aes(x = height_cm, # height as x-axis  
           y = case_control)) + # nest prevalence as y-axis  
  geom_point(size = 3, # size of points  
            alpha = 0.7, # opacity of points  
            shape = 21, # shape of points  
            color = "bisque3") + # color of points  
  geom_ribbon(data = preds, # using prediction data  
            aes(x = x,  
                ymin = conf.low, # lower confidence interval for ribbon  
                ymax = conf.high), # upper confidence interval for ribbon  
            fill = "lightblue", # specifying color of ribbon  
            alpha = 0.4, # opacity of ribbon  
            inherit.aes = FALSE) + # don't use ggplot aes  
  geom_line(data = preds, # data set is prediction  
           # setting axes  
           aes(x = x,  
               y = predicted),  
           color = "dodgerblue", # specifying line color  
           inherit.aes = FALSE) + # don't use ggplot aes  
  facet_wrap(~ ant_species_name) + # creating separate plots for each ant species  
  scale_y_continuous(limits = c(0, 1), # scaling axes  
                    breaks = c(0, 1)) +  
  labs(# creating custom labels and title  
       x = "Tree Height (cm)",  
       y = "Predicted Probability of Nest Occurrence",
```

```

title = "Predicted Probability of Nest Occurrence By Tree Height") +
# removing excess visuals with updated theme
theme_classic() +
# removing the legend
theme(legend.position = "none")

```



i. Write A Figure Caption

Figure 3: Predicted Probability of Nest Occurrence by Tree Height and Acacia Ant Species

Individual observations of nest occurrence are represented by points, where 0 indicates no nest was present and 1 indicates a nest was present. The red lines show predicted probabilities of nest occurrence from the selected logistic regression model, while the blue shaded regions represent 95% confidence intervals around the predictions. Panels display predictions separately for *Crematogaster mimosae*, *Crematogaster sjostedti*, and *Crematogaster nigriceps*.

Data source: Lujan, E., et al. (2023). Data, code, and metadata for: Symbiotic acacia ants drive nesting behavior by birds in an African savanna. Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.8373322>.

j. Calculate Model Predictions

```
# What is the probability of a nest occurrence at 600cm
ggpredict(model1, # using ggpredict on model 1
          terms = c("height_cm [600]", "ant_species_name")) # setting the desired height to 600cm
```

```
# Predicted probabilities of case_control
```

```
ant_species_name: Crematogaster sjostedti
```

height_cm	Predicted	95% CI
600	0.20	0.00, 0.99

```
ant_species_name: Crematogaster mimosae
```

height_cm	Predicted	95% CI
600	0.74	0.48, 0.90

```
ant_species_name: Crematogaster nigriceps
```

height_cm	Predicted	95% CI
600	1.00	1.00, 1.00

k. Interpret Your Results

The logistic regression model including tree height, acacia ant species, and their interaction was selected as the best model based on Akaike's Information Criterion ($AIC = 237.8$). Predicted nest occurrence probabilities at the maximum observed tree height of 600 cm differed substantially among ant species. Trees occupied by *Crematogaster mimosae* had a predicted nest occurrence probability of 0.74 (95% CI [0.48, 0.90]), while trees occupied by *Crematogaster sjostedti* had a much lower predicted probability of 0.20 (95% CI [0.00, 0.99]). In contrast, trees occupied by *Crematogaster nigriceps* had a predicted nest occurrence probability of 1.00 (95% CI [1.00, 1.00]). As tree height increased, the probability of nest occurrence generally increased, but the strength of this relationship depended on ant species (Figure 3). These results suggest that both tree height and acacia ant species influence bird nesting behavior, likely because different ant species vary in their defensive behavior and their effects on tree structure, which can alter the suitability of trees as nesting sites.

Problem 3: Affective and Exploratory Visualizations

a. Comparing Visualizations

How are the visualizations different from each other in the way you have represented your data?

The exploratory visualizations span between a bar chart comparing mean activity level per day of the week and a jitter plot examining if there is a direct relationship between time slept and activity level while the affective visualization is a bar chart that combines my predictor and response variables as well as my other predatory variables. The exploratory visualizations look to examine direct relationships between one predictor variable and the response while the the affective visualization serves as a holistic view of how general physical exertion and recovery habits influence overall daily activity level. It should also be noted that the affective visualization relies heavily on *color* while the exploratory visualizations use basic numerical-based figures.

What similarities do you see between all your visualizations?

The main takeaway from all of the visualizations is that there isn't just *one* deciding factor that directly influences my daily activity level. This is illustrated in contrasting the exploratory visualizations (comparing one predictor to the response variable) with the affective visualization: the exploratory pieces showcase *some* form of a relationship but not a necessarily strong one while the affective piece shows that the additional variables I measured also have a drastic impact on overall activity level. In other words, all the visualizations showcase that *multiple factors contribute to my overall daily activity level*.

What patterns (e.g. differences in means/counts/proportions/medians, trends through time, relationships between variables) do you see in each visualization? Are these different between visualizations? If so, why? If not, why not?

In first exploratory visualization (comparing daily activity per day of the week), during the week, mean daily step count is generally higher with Tuesday and Thursday exhibiting the highest overall steps taken while the weekend days (Saturday & Sunday) have the exhibit the lowest steps taken. In the second visualization (comparing time slept and activity level), there seems to be a somewhat negative correlation between time slept and activity level where activity level decreases as time slept increases. In comparing all three visualizations, the findings from the exploratory visualizations match that of the affective visualization where my main recovery days (weekends) have lower overall activity level.

What kinds of feedback did you get during week 9 in workshop or from the instructors? How did you implement or try those suggestions? If you tried and kept those suggestions, explain how and why; if not, explain why not.

During week 9, I didn't get much feedback from my peers other than the fact that they liked where I was going with my affective visualization. They also thought that the variables I used

to collect information my “study” were well thought out and supported finding an answer to my central question. The main feedback I got from instructors were regarding my exploratory visualizations and this was mainly just to clean up the plots which I did!

b. Designing An Analysis

Question: Is there a statistical relationship between time slept and activity level (measured in daily steps taken)?

Analysis: To understand whether there is a statistical relationship between total time slept (minutes) and activity level (measured in daily steps taken), I will run a correlation test. This is appropriate as based off my initial exploratory visualization, it seems that there is *some* form of a negative linear relationship between the total time slept and activity level the next day. However, because the relationship isn’t strictly obvious, I want to assess how correlated these variables are. Understanding this will aid in how I prioritize sleep in my every day life.

Variables Assessed

Predictor Variable: Total Time Slept On A Nightly Basis (Minutes)

Type: Numerical, Continuous

Response Variable: Total Steps Taken Daily

Type: Numerical, Discrete

c. Check Any Assumptions and Run Your Analysis

Checking Assumptions

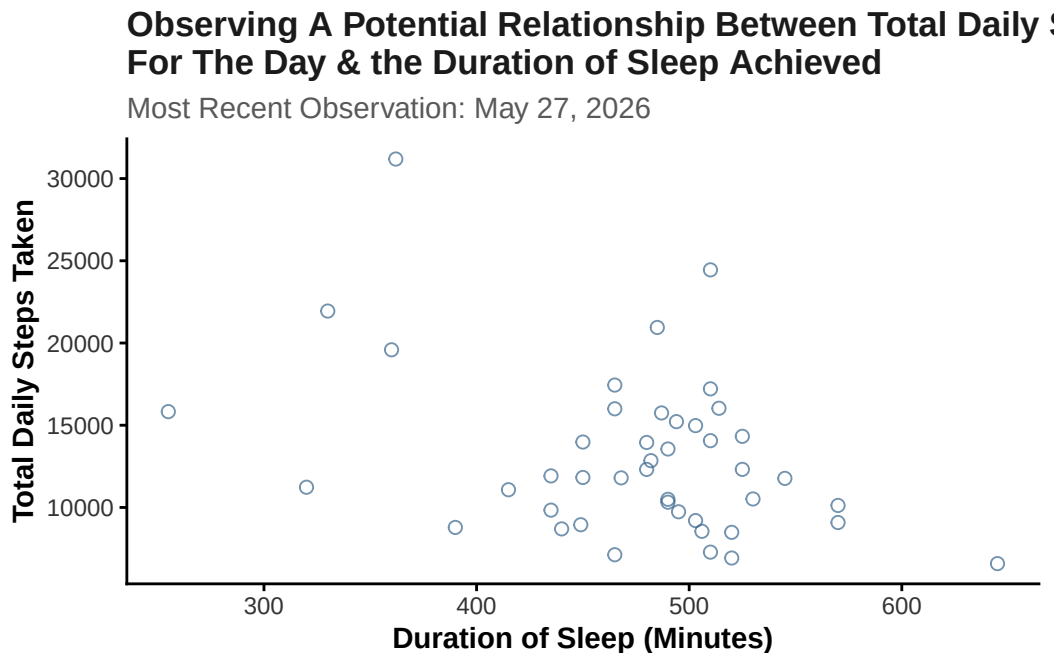
```
# cleaning my data before creating ggplot
my_data_clean <- step_count |>
  # cleaning names
  clean_names() |>
  # removing any NA values
  filter(!is.na(day_of_the_week))
```

```
#creating ggplot base layer
ggplot(data = my_data_clean,
  # setting axes to the desired variables
  mapping = aes(x = duration_of_sleep_minutes,
    y = total_steps_taken_for_the_day)) +
  # Adding a QQ plot
```

```

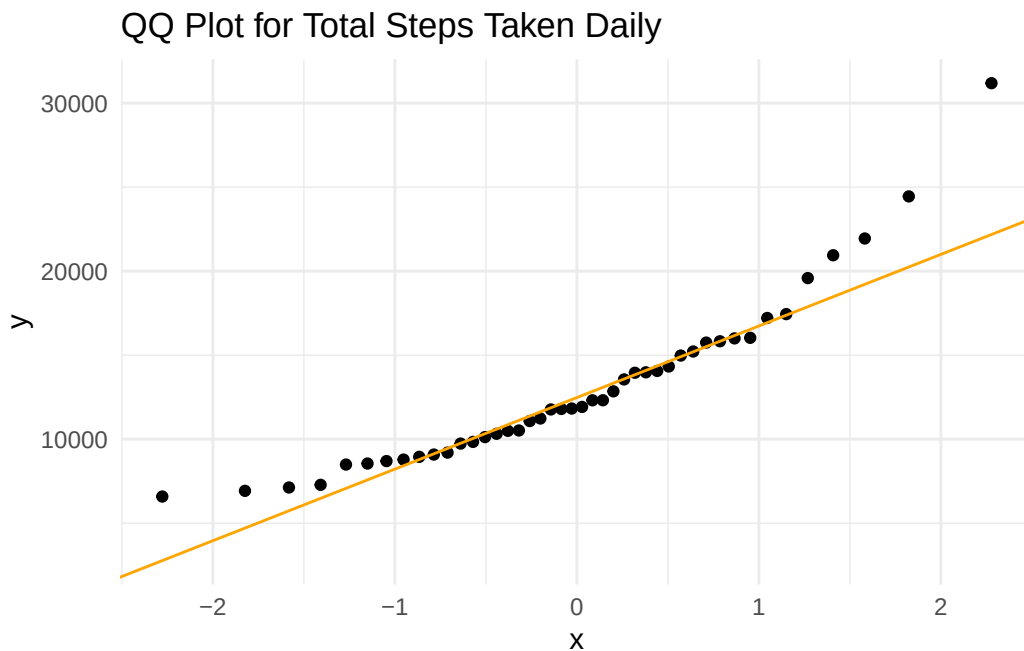
geom_point(color = "steelblue4", # specifying color
           size = 2, # specifying size
           alpha = 0.7, # changing opacity
           shape = 21) + # changing the shape
# Adding custom labels for the x and y axis
labs(x = "Duration of Sleep (Minutes)",
     y = "Total Daily Steps Taken",
     title = "Observing A Potential Relationship Between Total Daily Steps Taken
For The Day & the Duration of Sleep Achieved",
     subtitle = "Most Recent Observation: May 27, 2026") +
# Updating the theme to remove grid lines
theme_classic() +
# Customizing the theme elements
theme(plot.title = element_text(face = "bold", # bolding the title
                                color = "gray10"), #making the title gray
      plot.subtitle = element_text(color = "gray35"), # choosing color
      axis.title = element_text(face = "bold"), # bolding the axes
      axis.text = element_text(color = "gray20")) # axes color

```



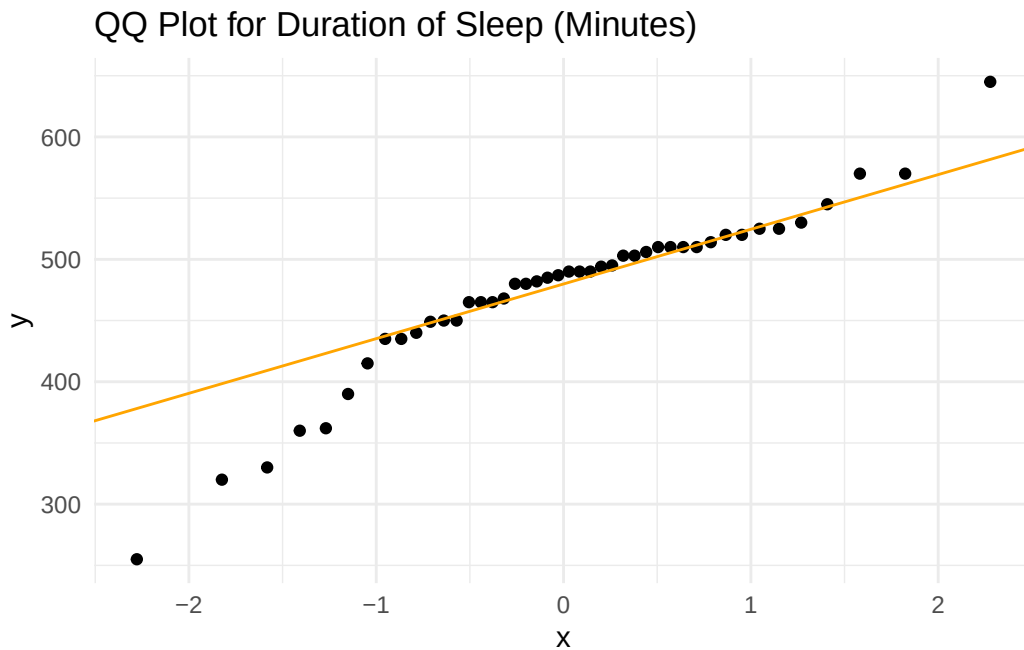
Note: There seems to be some type of negative relationship between the two but need to ensure the normality of the data before running the correlation test.

```
# ggplot as base layer
ggplot(data = my_data_clean,
       mapping = aes(sample = total_steps_taken_for_the_day)) + # specifying use of total s
# first layer is QQ plot
geom_qq() +
# second layer is QQ line
geom_qq_line(color = "orange") + # making line red
# updating theme
theme_minimal() +
# updating title
labs(title = "QQ Plot for Total Steps Taken Daily")
```



```
# ggplot as the base layer
ggplot(data = my_data_clean,
       mapping = aes(sample = duration_of_sleep_minutes)) +
# specifying use of sleep duration
# first layer is the qq plot
geom_qq() +
# second layer is the qq plot line
geom_qq_line(color = "orange") + # making line red
# updating theme
theme_minimal() +
```

```
# updating title
labs(title = "QQ Plot for Duration of Sleep (Minutes)")
```



Note: The data for both Total Daily Steps Taken and Duration of Sleep (minutes) appear *relatively normal*. However, the scatter plot directly comparing the variables showcases there could be other factors influencing the relationship. As a result, I believe running both a Pearson's & Spearman-rank correlation test and then comparing the results of both would be beneficial while enhancing the rigor of my analysis.

Running Proposed Analysis

```
# Conducting a Pearson Correlation test
cor.test(my_data_clean$total_steps_taken_for_the_day,
         my_data_clean$duration_of_sleep_minutes,
         method = "pearson") # specifying which correlation test
```

Pearson's product-moment correlation

data: my_data_clean\$total_steps_taken_for_the_day and my_data_clean\$duration_of_sleep_minutes

```
t = -2.6228, df = 42, p-value = 0.0121
alternative hypothesis: true correlation is not equal to 0
95 percent confidence interval:
 -0.60468177 -0.08807612
sample estimates:
      cor
-0.3751471
```

```
# Conducting a Spearman-rank correlation test
cor.test(my_data_clean$total_steps_taken_for_the_day,
         my_data_clean$duration_of_sleep_minutes,
         method = "spearman") # specifying which correlation test
```

```
Warning in cor.test.default(my_data_clean$total_steps_taken_for_the_day, :
Cannot compute exact p-value with ties
```

Spearman's rank correlation rho

```
data: my_data_clean$total_steps_taken_for_the_day and my_data_clean$duration_of_sleep_minutes
S = 17801, p-value = 0.0955
alternative hypothesis: true rho is not equal to 0
sample estimates:
      rho
-0.2544878
```

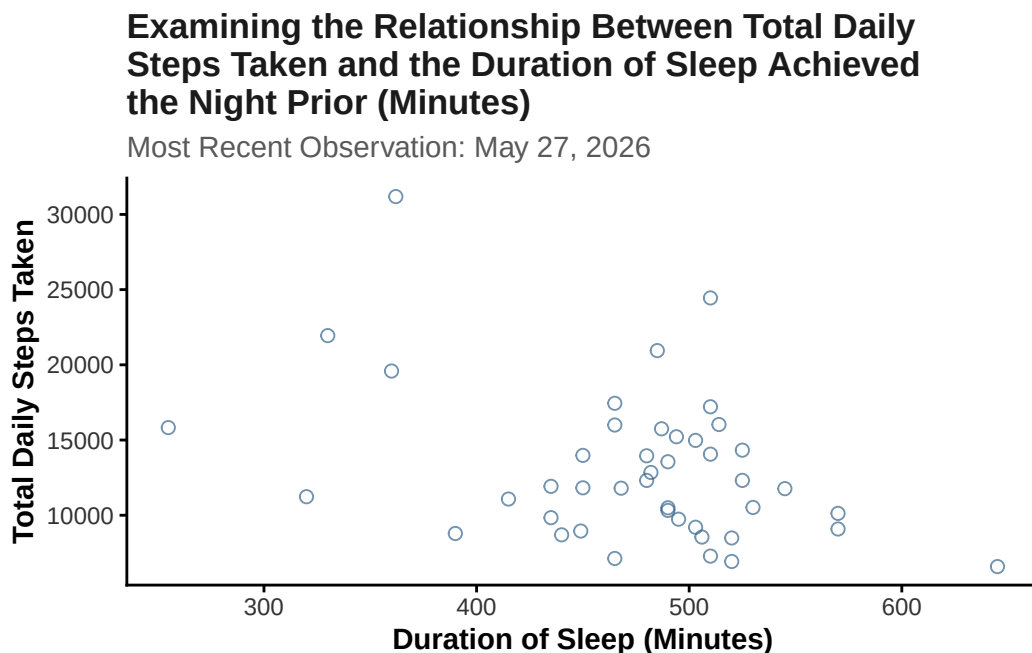
d. Create a Visualization

```
#creating ggplot base layer
ggplot(data = my_data_clean,
       # setting variables for the axes
       mapping = aes(x = duration_of_sleep_minutes,
                     y = total_steps_taken_for_the_day)) +
# Adding a QQ plot
geom_point(color = "steelblue4", # choosing color
          size = 2, # setting point size
          alpha = 0.7, # opacity
          shape = 21) + # specific shape
# Adding custom labels for the x and y axis
labs(x = "Duration of Sleep (Minutes)",
```

```

y = "Total Daily Steps Taken",
title = "Examining the Relationship Between Total Daily
Steps Taken and the Duration of Sleep Achieved
the Night Prior (Minutes)",
subtitle = "Most Recent Observation: May 27, 2026") +
# Updating the theme to remove grid lines
theme_classic() +
# Customizing the theme elements
theme(plot.title = element_text(face = "bold", # bolding the title
                                color = "gray10"), #making the title gray
      plot.subtitle = element_text(color = "gray35"), # choosing color
      axis.title = element_text(face = "bold"), # bolding the axes
      axis.text = element_text(color = "gray20")) # axes color

```



e. Write a Caption

Figure Caption:

The figure depicts the relationship between sleep duration (minutes) shown on the x-axis and total daily step count across all observations collected during the study period shown on the y-axis. The points represent the individual observations recorded during the study period.

